

NE at BUF · Sunday 2026-10-04 13:00 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: NE +7.0 / BUF -7.0, total 48.5. Trip: NE → BUF 382 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: NE 7 days, BUF 7 days. Roof: outdoors.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	NE	A at SEA	10–13	+3.0	push	287	109	-4.6	-6.6	+1.4	0.41	3
2	NE	H vs PIT	20–3	-4.5	cover	344	136	-1.3	-1.9	-22.2	0.43	2
3	NE	A at JAX	6–35	+3.0	miss	328	83	-13.9	-15.9	+11.8	0.37	3
1	BUF	A at HOU	36–31	-1.5	cover	420	86	+14.5	+15.6	+5.6	0.41	0
2	BUF	H vs DET	41–31	-5.5	cover	451	203	+15.0	+31.2	+18.3	0.59	0
3	BUF	H vs LAC	24–16	-7.0	cover	380	176	-0.4	-4.2	-4.5	0.48	5

Last game EPA (PBP): NE off -15.9, def allowed +11.8, net -27.8, SR 0.37. BUF off -4.2, def allowed -4.5, net +0.3, SR 0.48. Records: NE 1–2, BUF 3–0. ATS: NE 1–1, BUF 3–0.

2. Lookahead and rest

- NE: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 29). 7 days rest. Week 5: home vs LV, non-division, Sunday early window.
- BUF: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 8). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs LA, non-division, Monday night.

3. Sides — BUF -7.0

BUF (home favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home favorite	265–294–16	47.4%	575
Sunday early window home favorite	145–150–10	49.2%	305
division home favorite	74–84–5	46.8%	163
home fav -7 to -9.5	51–60–3	45.9%	114
division home fav -7 to -9.5	16–14–2	53.3%	32
Sunday early window division home favorite	36–53–3	40.4%	92
Sunday early window fav -7 to -9.5	39–45–2	46.4%	86

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a win as favorite, Sunday early window division home favorite	9–22–1	29.0%	32
off a win, home fav -7 to -9.5	25–42–3	37.3%	70
next game is prime time, home fav -7 to -9.5	8–18–2	30.8%	28
equal rest, Sunday early window division home favorite	19–33–2	36.5%	54
rush yards ≥ 150 last, Sunday early window division home favorite	7–16	30.4%	23
next game is road non-division, Sunday early window division home favorite	19–32–2	37.3%	53
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window division home favorite	16–28–1	36.4%	45
TO ≥ 3 last, home favorite	28–43–3	39.4%	74
off a win, opponent off a loss, home fav -7 to -9.5	17–29–2	37.0%	48
next opponent is a favorite over them ($n_{line} > 0$), division home fav -7 to -9.5	9–3–1	75.0%	13
off a win as favorite, home fav -7 to -9.5	20–32–2	38.5%	54
next game is road, Sunday early window division home favorite	27–40–2	40.3%	69
opponent off an ATS miss, home favorite	124–150–8	45.3%	282
TO ≥ 3 last, Sunday early window division home favorite	3–8	27.3%	11
won last despite off EPA ≤ -1 , Sunday early window division home favorite	5–11	31.2%	16

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
rush yards ≥ 150 last, division home favorite	14–23	37.8%	37
off a win, opponent off a loss, division home favorite	18–28–2	39.1%	48
off a home game, home favorite	75–94–4	44.4%	173
won last despite off EPA ≤ -1 , Sunday early window home favorite	11–19–1	36.7%	31
off a home game, Sunday early window division home favorite	11–19	36.7%	30
off a 1-score win, Sunday early window home favorite	48–35–5	57.8%	88
equal rest, home favorite	154–180–10	46.1%	344
next opponent is a favorite over them ($n_line > 0$), home favorite	116–138–5	45.7%	259
next game is road, home favorite	179–206–8	46.5%	393
off a win as favorite, division home favorite	22–32–1	40.7%	55
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window fav -7 to -9.5	23–33–1	41.1%	57
opponent off a loss, Sunday early window division home favorite	23–33–2	41.1%	58
2nd straight home game, home fav -7 to -9.5	15–23–1	39.5%	39

Wide populations ($n \geq 300$): equal rest, home favorite, next game is road, home favorite. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

4. Sides — NE +7.0

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

NE (road dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road dog	294–265–16	52.6%	575
Sunday early window road dog	150–145–10	50.8%	305
division road dog	84–74–5	53.2%	163
road dog +7 to +9.5	60–51–3	54.1%	114
division road dog +7 to +9.5	14–16–2	46.7%	32
Sunday early window division road dog	53–36–3	59.6%	92
Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	45–39–2	53.6%	86

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window division road dog	46–21	68.7%	67
trip 200–1000 mi, division road dog	72–42–2	63.2%	116
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog	179–135–6	57.0%	320
opponent off a win, road dog +7 to +9.5	42–25–3	62.7%	70
equal rest, Sunday early window division road dog	33–19–2	63.5%	54
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window road dog	107–81–3	56.9%	191
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window division road dog	28–16–1	63.6%	45
off a loss, opponent off a win, road dog +7 to +9.5	29–17–2	63.0%	48
off a loss by 20+, Sunday early window road dog	23–13	63.9%	36
off EPA ≤ -1 last, Sunday early window division road dog	28–17	62.2%	45
off an ATS miss, road dog	150–124–8	54.7%	282
net EPA ≤ -10 last, Sunday early window division road dog	21–12–1	63.6%	34
scored ≤ 17 last, Sunday early window division road dog	22–13–1	62.9%	36
off a loss, opponent off a win, division road dog	28–18–2	60.9%	48
off a loss, opponent off a win, Sunday early window division road dog	19–11–1	63.3%	31
equal rest, road dog	180–154–10	53.9%	344
scored ≤ 21 last, Sunday early window division road dog	26–17–1	60.5%	44
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	33–23–1	58.9%	57

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a loss, Sunday early window division road dog	33–23–2	58.9%	58
outdoors, Sunday early window division road dog	35–25–3	58.3%	63
0 time zones, division road dog +7 to +9.5	5–10–2	33.3%	17
equal rest, Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	29–20–2	59.2%	51
opponent off a win, Sunday early window division road dog	30–21–2	58.8%	53
2nd straight road game, Sunday early window division road dog	19–12	61.3%	31
next game is home non-division, division road dog	34–45–3	43.0%	82
allowed ≥ 30 last, road dog +7 to +9.5	25–17	59.5%	42
trip 200–1000 mi, division road dog +7 to +9.5	11–6–1	64.7%	18
equal rest, road dog +7 to +9.5	40–30–2	57.1%	72

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): trip 200–1000 mi, road dog, equal rest, road dog. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

5. Total 48.5

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week, total 45–49	2–9	18.2%	11
home fav –7 or more, both off EPA ≤ -1 last	12–23	34.3%	35
both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total ≥ 47	20–10	66.7%	30
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week	14–25	35.9%	39
home fav –7 or more, total ≥ 47	26–39–1	40.0%	66
outdoors, both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total ≥ 47	13–6	68.4%	19
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week, total ≥ 47	4–10	28.6%	14
home fav –7 or more, both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total 45–49	3–8	27.3%	11
division game, both off EPA ≤ -1 last	23–34	40.4%	57
Sunday early window, outdoors, total 45–49	84–67–1	55.6%	152
both off EPA ≤ -1 last	78–96	44.8%	174
division game, both teams went under last week	30–41	42.3%	71
division game, Sunday early window, total ≥ 47	29–20–1	59.2%	50
division game, both teams went under last week, total 45–49	8–14	36.4%	22
division game, both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total ≥ 47	7–3	70.0%	10
Sunday early window, both off EPA ≤ -1 last	47–60	43.9%	107
Sunday early window, both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total ≥ 47	11–6	64.7%	17
Sunday early window, total 45–49	106–90–1	54.1%	197
both teams went under last week, both off EPA ≤ -1 last, total ≥ 47	9–5	64.3%	14
division game, both teams went under last week, total ≥ 47	5–9	35.7%	14
division game, home fav –7 or more, total 45–49	9–14	39.1%	23
outdoors, total ≥ 47	109–124–3	46.8%	236

6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: applies to NE
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: applies to BUF
- 2nd straight road game: applies to NE
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤ 10 last: applies to NE
- short week: no
- trip ≥ 1000 mi: no

- TO ≥ 3 last: applies to BUF, NE
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

7. Stack, without double-counting

Stack floor is $n \geq 20$ (tables use $n \geq 10$). Traits are added by largest parent-minus-child gap (the stack's pct against the pct of the games the trait removes), not by a fixed order. Under each stack: by-season W-L, cover-margin quartiles with signed tails, parent-minus-child (the stack without each trait, and the games that trait removed), the anchor's complement, the stack split by line bucket, a contrary cross (the team's own traits that run against it on the anchor, crossed into the stack), and a hold-out (traits chosen on 2015–20 only, printed on 2021–25).

- **BUF -7.0** — one population: division home fav -7 to -9.5; off a win. ATS 8–11–2 (42.1%, $n=21$). Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): equal rest, off a 1-score win, off a cover, off a win as favorite, off a home game, 2nd straight home game, allowed ≤ 17 last, allowed ≤ 21 last....
- By season: 15:2-2 17:2-0 18:1-1 20:1-1 21:1-1 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:0-1 25:1-3
- Cover margin: median -1.5, q_{25}/q_{75} -9.0/+13.0; $P(>+7)$ 0.33, $P(<-7)$ 0.33
- Parent minus child: without 'off a win': 16–14–2 (53.3%, $n=32$), the games it removed: 8–3 (72.7%, $n=11$)
- Anchor alone 16–14–2 (53.3%, $n=32$); anchor minus stack 8–3 (72.7%, $n=11$)
- Stack by line bucket: -7 to -9.5 8–11–2 (42.1%, $n=21$)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): off a win, opponent off a loss: 5–8–1 (38.5%, $n=14$) → in stack 5–8–1 (38.5%, $n=14$) | off a win as favorite: 6–9–1 (40.0%, $n=16$) → in stack 6–9–1 (40.0%, $n=16$) | off a cover: 6–8–1 (42.9%, $n=15$) → in stack 6–8–1 (42.9%, $n=15$) | allowed ≤ 21 last: 7–8 (46.7%, $n=15$) → in stack 4–8 (33.3%, $n=12$)
- Hold-out (traits chosen on 2015–20 only: Sunday early window fav -7 to -9.5; next game is road; next game is road non-division): 2015–20 10–12 (45.5%, $n=22$) → 2021–25 8–11 (42.1%, $n=19$)
- **NE +7.0** — one population: division road dog +7 to +9.5; opponent off a win. ATS 11–8–2 (57.9%, $n=21$). Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): equal rest, trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, off a loss, off a loss by 10+, off a loss by 20+, off an ATS miss, off a loss as dog....
- By season: 15:2-2 17:0-2 18:1-1 20:1-1 21:1-1 22:1-0 23:1-0 24:1-0 25:3-1
- Cover margin: median +1.5, q_{25}/q_{75} -13.0/+9.0; $P(>+7)$ 0.33, $P(<-7)$ 0.33
- Parent minus child: without 'opponent off a win': 14–16–2 (46.7%, $n=32$), the games it removed: 3–8 (27.3%, $n=11$)
- Anchor alone 14–16–2 (46.7%, $n=32$); anchor minus stack 3–8 (27.3%, $n=11$)
- Stack by line bucket: +7 to +9.5 11–8–2 (57.9%, $n=21$)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): 0 time zones: 5–10–2 (33.3%, $n=17$) → in stack 4–6–2 (40.0%, $n=12$) | next game is home: 7–12–1 (36.8%, $n=20$) → in stack 6–7–1 (46.2%, $n=14$) | outdoors: 7–11–1 (38.9%, $n=19$) → in stack 5–5–1 (50.0%, $n=11$) | off a loss by 10+: 4–7 (36.4%, $n=11$) → in stack 3–3 (50.0%, $n=6$)
- Hold-out (traits chosen on 2015–20 only: Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5; next game is home; off a loss): 2015–20 9–12 (42.9%, $n=21$) → 2021–25 9–7 (56.2%, $n=16$)
- **Total 48.5, tightest cut clearing $n = 20$:** home fav -7 or more, both off EPA ≤ -1 last — O–U 12–23 (34.3%, $n=35$).
- By season (O–U): 15:1-1 16:0-2 17:3-3 18:1-2 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:1-1 22:1-3 23:0-4 24:0-2 25:2-4
- Total margin (points – line): median -4.5, q_{25}/q_{75} -10.8/+2.8; $P(>+7)$ 0.17, $P(<-7)$ 0.40
- By total band: ≤ 39 0–3 ($n=3$); 40–44 8–9 ($n=17$); 45–49 3–8 ($n=11$); ≥ 50 1–2 ($n=3$)

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).